



TRUCKS CARRY wood from a deforested area in the Amazon rainforest near Belém, Brazil, on Wednesday.

MAURO PIMENTEL AFP

Trump’s foreign policy is testing once-unwavering MAGA base

Military strikes, visas, peace deals rankle ‘America first’ stalwarts

By ANA CEBALLOS

WASHINGTON — On the campaign trail, Donald Trump was unapologetic about putting America first. He promised to secure the nation’s borders, strengthen the domestic workforce and be tough on countries he thought were taking advantage of the United States.

Now, 10 months into his second term, the president

is facing backlash from some conservatives who say he is too focused on matters abroad, whether it’s seeking a change of governments in Venezuela, brokering peace deals in Ukraine and Gaza or extending a \$20-billion currency swap for Argentina. The criticism has grown in recent days after Trump expressed support for granting more visas to foreign students and skilled immigrant workers.

The cracks in the Make America Great Again movement, which have been more pronounced in recent weeks, underscore how Trump’s once impenetrable political base is wavering as the president appears to embrace a more global approach to governing.

“I have to view the presidency as a worldwide situation, not locally,” Trump said last week when asked to address the criticism at an

Oval Office event. “We could have a world that’s on fire where wars come to our shores very easily if you had a bad president.”

For backers of Trump’s MAGA movement, the conflict is forcing some to weigh loyalty to an “America first” ideology over a president they have long supported and who, in some cases, inspired them to get involved in the political process.

[See MAGA, A7]

No easy fixes on inflation for president

Like Biden before him, Trump finds he can’t tame rising prices that are frustrating voters.

By JOSH BOAK

WASHINGTON — President Trump’s problems with fixing the high cost of living might be giving voters a feeling of déjà vu.

Just like the president who came before him,

Trump is trying to sell the country on his plans to create factory jobs. The Republican says he wants to lower prescription drug costs, as did Democratic President Biden. Both tried to shame companies for price increases.

Trump is even leaning on a message that echoes Biden’s assertions in 2021 that elevated inflation is a “transitory” problem that will soon vanish.

“We’re going to be hitting 1.5% pretty soon,” Trump

told reporters last week. “It’s all coming down.”

Even as Trump keeps saying an economic boom is around the corner, there are signs that he has already exhausted voters’ patience as his campaign promises to quickly fix inflation have gone unfulfilled.

Election discontent

Voters in this month’s elections swung hard to Democrats over concerns about affordability. That has left Trump, who dismisses

his weak polling on the economy as fake, floating half-formed ideas to ease financial pressures.

He is promising a \$2,000 rebate on his tariffs and said he may offer 50-year mortgages — 20 years longer than any available now — to reduce the size of monthly payments. On Friday, Trump scrapped his tariffs on beef, coffee, tea, fruit juice, cocoa, spices, bananas, oranges, tomatoes and certain fertilizers, ac-

[See Inflation, A7]

More than a decade ago, Tinder became the hottest dating app, transforming modern romance by making it possible for singles to swipe through people’s profiles, match and meet up.

Now, Tinder is fighting to keep the flame alive. Sometimes in unexpected ways.

Last month, it convinced UCLA students to meet in a big group in the real world. They danced together as 26-year-old DJ Disco Lines played a set at the Fowler Museum on campus.

Instead of spending time swiping, students swayed on the dance floor under disco balls, holding up their smartphones as they listened to Disco Lines’ hot remix of Tinashe’s song “No Broke Boys” — a track about setting high standards in romantic relationships.

Tinder strives to get its groove back by adding offline events

Gen Z users longing for more than the photo experience

By Queenie Wong

The West Hollywood company had partnered with the DJ and college influencers who posted videos with that song on TikTok and Instagram to promote the event and the app. Ahead of the show, Tinder also encouraged people on social media to download the app to find the event’s location and time.

“Swipe right. Swipe right. Swipe right,” Disco Lines said in the videos as he mimicked the motion.

Young daters today want more from dating apps than an opportunity to swipe, said Mark Kantor, Tinder’s head of product.

“Gen Z wants to connect authentically. They believe in romance. They’re open to serendipity,” he said. “They’re hopeful, but they want to go beyond just the photo experience.”

[See Tinder, A8]

At 90, politically weak Palestinian leader struggles for a role in Gaza

By LEE KEATH

CAIRO — Palestinian Authority President Mahmoud Abbas turned 90 over the weekend, still holding authoritarian power in tiny pockets of the West Bank but marginalized and weakened by Israel, deeply unpopular among Palestinians and struggling for a say in a postwar Gaza Strip.

The world’s second-oldest serving president — after Cameroon’s 92-year-old Paul Biya — Abbas has been

in office for 20 years, and for nearly the entire time has failed to hold elections. His weakness has left Palestinians leaderless, critics say, at a time when they face an existential crisis and hopes for establishing a Palestinian state, the centerpiece of Abbas’ agenda, appear dimmer than ever.

Palestinians say Israel’s campaign against the militant group Hamas that has decimated Gaza amounts to genocide, a view echoed by many international legal experts, organizations and

other countries. Israel denies the accusation and has tightened its lock on the West Bank, where Jewish settlements are expanding and attacks by settlers on Palestinians are increasing. Right-wing allies of Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu are pressing for outright annexation, a step that would doom any remaining possibility for statehood.

For now, the U.S. has bent to Israel’s refusal to allow Abbas’ Palestinian Author-

[See Abbas, A3]

An Amazon climate summit full of contrasts

Wealth and scarcity, development and conservation at Brazil’s COP30.

By MELODY GUTIERREZ

BELÉM, Brazil — Two stark-white cruise ships loomed over a muddy Amazonian estuary, an odd sight from a beach where two children waded in the water.

The diesel-powered vessels towered over the impoverished riverfront neighborhood where trash littered the ground and a rainbow sheen from household and street runoff glistened on top of rain puddles.

The cruise liners — with their advertised swimming pools, seafont promenades and an array of restaurants and bars — were brought in to house thousands of delegates attending the 12-day United Nations COP30 climate summit in Belém, which ends Friday. The ships helped address a housing crunch created by an influx of roughly 50,000 people into the capital of Pará in

northern Brazil.

Along with being a global economic powerhouse, Brazil is also one of the planet’s most important climate actors. The South American nation is home to tropical rainforests that absorb vast amounts of carbon dioxide but are increasingly threatened by deforestation and a drying Amazon.

The contrast — a climate conference relying on emissions-heavy cruise ships — has become the defining image of this year’s COP30, where wealth and scarcity sit side by side.

Belém residents said they felt a mix of curiosity and excitement watching the influx of foreigners, eager to show a culture that is often overshadowed by the country’s larger southern cities.

Many described COP30 as the first time the world had paused long enough to take notice of the people living at the mouth of the Amazon River, where locally grown açaí is sold on nearly every block. The region supplies the vast majority of Brazil’s açaí crop and much [See Summit, A8]



LARRY VALENZUELA CalMatters

COMPLAINTS in a federal case allege sex abuse and harassment at Golden State Annex in McFarland.

Immigrants allege assault by guard in detention facility

By ANDREA CASTILLO

WASHINGTON — For more than a year, detainees at a California immigrant detention center said, they were summoned from their dorms to a lieutenant’s office late at night. Hours frequently passed, they said, before they were sent back to their dorms.

What they allege happened in the office became the subject of federal complaints, which accuse Lt. Quin, then an administrative manager, of harassing, threatening and coercing immigrants into sexual acts at the Golden State Annex in McFarland. A person with that name worked in a higher-ranking post, as chief of security, at the Alexandria Staging Facility in Louisiana until August — the same

month The Times sent questions to the company that operates the facilities.

The Department of Homeland Security said it could not substantiate the allegations. According to an attorney for one of the detainees, the California attorney general’s office opened an investigation into the matter.

Immigrant advocates point to the case as one of many allegations of abuse in U.S. immigration facilities, within a system that they say fails to properly investigate.

In three complaints reviewed by The Times that were filed under the Federal Tort Claims Act (FTCA) to a watchdog agency and with Homeland Security, detainees accused Quin of sexual assault, harassment and [See Detainees, A6]



John D. and Catherine T. MacArthur Foundation

ALICE WONG DIES

The “cyborg oracle,” a California disability rights advocate who used wit, creativity and occasional shock to fight for justice, was 51. CALIFORNIA, B1

Rams hold off Seahawks rally

The offense struggles but the defense dominates, intercepting Seattle four times in 21-19 win. SPORTS, D1

Name change for the SAG Awards

The guild rebrands its prizes as the Actor Awards after moving the ceremony to Netflix. ENTERTAINMENT, E1

Weather

Heavy rain. L.A. Basin: 61/49. B5

